

Samsung Rugby II

AT&T has announced Samsung's Rugby II rugged phone which will feature a 2 MP camera, A-GPS, voice guided navigation via AT&T's Navigator

Wearable computer concept

Sony Nextep Computer concept is a bracelet shaped computer with an OLED touchscreen display, holographic projector and a pull out keyboard

Industry connect

Grow

Rohit Sharma, CEO, Zapak Digital Entertainment on their acquisition of Codemasters

What does this acquisition mean for Zapak and its future?

If you look at the Western markets, by and the large, the console market is the bigger space. So this (acquisition) helps us get a global footprint, in partnership with one of the largest gaming companies, which has development and distribution capabilities all across the world.

Why Codemasters specifically?

One reason is they have very strong capabilities in cricket games, which is something we can take online and to the mobile space, globally. They also have a very strong IP in racing, as well as the Formula 1 franchise, which is a

great franchise to have. They are strong company, with revenues of \$150 million, and are growing well. They also have the right DMA [Designated Market Area] and a good development team. All these factors helped us take the call.

So, are there lots of cricket games in the pipeline? Anything IPL related?

As for IPL-related games, I cannot comment, but yes, definitely lots of cricket games.

Does Zapak now have any plans to make console games as well?

Sooner or later, we will use Codemasters' development skills to bring online games to India, creating a lot of browser based games and so on. Codemasters will continue to make console games for the European and American markets, and if we get the right IP and the right idea, we will also make them for the Indian market. Right now we will use

their skills and IPs for the Indian market in whatever form they are.

Any plans to create an Indian MMOG?

Yes, why not? They have a very strong online team, and we have been wanting to create intellectual property in the MMOG field, because we think that is where the value will be these days.

Is this acquisition a two-way street in terms of technology? Will Codemasters also benefit from Zapak's expertise?

Yes, it is. Codemasters have a strong IP which they have not leveraged in the mobile space, and with our company called Jump Games, we are very strong in that area. So we can use their IP to develop and distribute mobile games globally. And again with our core understanding of the online business, I think there is tremendous opportunity to work together in creating online games. **d**

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